

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 95

By Reedy

A RESOLUTION to honor the memory of Joyce Gregory.

WHEREAS, the long and distinguished history of pupil transportation includes many episodes of dedicated service by school bus drivers, who daily serve and protect the children under their charge in ways both great and small; and

WHEREAS, school bus drivers are truly real-life heroes; unfortunately, Joyce Gregory, a Stewart County school bus driver, lost her life while discharging her duties some twenty years ago; and

WHEREAS, on March 3, 2005, Joyce Gregory was engaged in her usual task of picking up students and transporting them to Dover Elementary School and Stewart County High School when tragedy struck on a rural road just outside Cumberland City; and

WHEREAS, as she stopped the bus to pick up students, a fourteen-year-old male with a personal vendetta against the bus driver fatally shot Ms. Gregory; thankfully, none of the twenty-four students already on the bus were injured; and

WHEREAS, some twenty years later, we faithfully remember Ms. Gregory's courage and commitment in the face of death, as do the loved ones who cherish her memory; and

WHEREAS, she gave her life while providing a means for the children under her charge to receive a quality education and achieve a brighter future; and

WHEREAS, we are eternally grateful to Joyce Gregory for her ultimate sacrifice in advancing the cause of education as a role model and positive influence for children, and her bountiful life should be commemorated; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE

CONCURRING, that we honor the memory of Joyce Gregory, praising her service as a school bus driver and paying tribute to her courage and resolve on the fateful morning of March 3, 2005.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.